TOWER DEFENSE & STRATEGY

# Squnchies

*Squish back the Snarls. Keep the calm.*

A cozy, hands-on tower defense game where a child's squishy stress toys come alive at night to defend the Hush Light from the Snarls, the jittery little gremlins of stress. Your towers are fidget toys, and you squeeze them.



SECTION 1

# Concept

**Squnchies** is a cozy, tactile tower defense game for mobile. When the lights go out, a child's squishy stress toys wake up on the bedroom shelf to defend the **Hush Light**, the warm nightlight that holds the room's calm, from the **Snarls**: jittery, spiky little gremlins of stress that creep in along the shelf each night. You place **Squnchies**, squishy gel creatures each with their own texture, shape, and job, along the path the Snarls take toward the light. They squish, splat, bounce, and stretch to stop the advance.

The twist that makes Squnchies its own thing: **your towers are fidget toys, and you fidget with them.** Tap and hold any Squnchie to squeeze it. It deforms under your finger with a deep, satisfying give (sound and haptics together) as a charge ring fills. Release to unleash a charged attack: a shockwave squish, a goo splat, a big bounce. Time the release on the peak of the toy's wobble for a **perfect squish** and a bigger payoff.



**Layer 1 · The calm board**
Squnchies auto-squish on their own gentle rhythm. The board hums along by itself. Low effort, low stress, soothing to watch.

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**Layer 2 · Your hands**
Tap and hold a toy to squeeze it. It deforms, charges, and on release unleashes a big squish. The active, sensory heart of the game.

So the game runs on two layers at once: the calm, automatic rhythm of a tower defense board, and the hands-on pleasure of squeezing a stress toy exactly when it counts. You are not just watching your defenses work. You are squeezing the stress out of the night.

THE FANTASY

***Turn a creeping wave of anxiety into a soft, glowing, perfectly defended calm, one squish at a time.***

SECTION 2

# Target Player

Squnchies is for the person who reaches for something to fidget with to take the edge off the day. Concretely, four overlapping players:



### The fidgeter

Keeps a squishy toy on the desk, clicks a pen in meetings, reaches for the phone in the in-between moments of the day.



### The satisfying-content fan

Watches slime, soap-cutting, and kinetic-sand videos for the sensory hit. Squnchies lets them do it, not just watch.



### The lapsed strategist

Likes tower defense's set-up-then-pay-off loop but bounces off the genre's complexity and punishing difficulty.



### The collector

Comes from a hobby built on collecting textures, colors, and limited drops. Wants a shelf to fill.

**The core profile:** a casual mobile player who wants **5 to 10 minute sessions** on a commute, in a waiting room, or to wind down before bed. One-handed, portrait, pick-up-and-put-down.

**Why the design fits them.** Short, self-contained waves respect a fragmented schedule. The squeeze-to-charge mechanic gives restless hands something to do. The difficulty curve is forgiving and the failure state is gentle: you do not die, the light just dims and you try the night again. The glowing art and soft sound are tuned to lower your shoulders, not raise your heart rate. It is a strategy game you reach for to feel *better*, not to feel tested.

IN ONE LINE

***Made for restless hands and tired evenings: a tower defense game whose job is to calm you down.***

SECTION 3

# Core Loop

Every wave is the same five-beat cycle. Most of it hums along on its own; then a spike of pressure invites you to lean in and squeeze.




**Read the night**

A calm beat. See the path, your toys, your Squish, and a preview of what is coming.




**Place & arrange**

Spend Squish to drop or upgrade Squnchies. Each type covers the path differently.




**The wave creeps in**

Snarls march. Toys auto-squish on their own. The calm layer ticks along.




**Fidget the line**

Tap and hold a toy to squeeze. Hold for the big attack. Release on the wobble for a perfect squish.




**Resolve & soothe**

The wave clears, Snarls pop into calm, you collect Squish, the Hush Light pulses warmer. Breathe.

**What makes the rhythm** is the contrast between the automatic and the manual. The board mostly runs itself (low stress), and then a wave of pressure pulls you in to choose *which* toy to squeeze and *when*, while the board ticks underneath you.

**Why one cycle differs from the next:** the Snarl mix changes what is worth squeezing. A Splatter squeeze matters against a crowd; a Stretcher squeeze matters against a lone fast Spark. And your Squish budget forces a fresh place-versus-upgrade-versus-save choice each time. The engine runs because every wave is a small, legible puzzle wrapped in a sensory reward.

## Where the strategy lives

### The economy choice

Squish is always scarce, so each wave is a real call. Say you can afford one move with a Knot incoming: upgrade your Squisher so it finally one-shots Jitters, add a second Splatter to thin the crowd trailing the Knot, or bank it toward a Stretcher still two waves out of reach. Wide and cheap, or deep and slow: you cannot do all three, and the wave decides which is right.

### The placement choice

Where a toy sits decides what it can reach. A slow-goo Splatter earns its cost on a bend where Snarls bunch up; a long-range Stretcher wants the open straightaway; a Boinger holds the last stretch before the Hush Light, bouncing back anything that slips the line. Branching Rooms split the path in two and make you commit your coverage to one lane or spread it thin across both.

THE CORE MECHANIC, IN ONE SENTENCE

***Squeeze the right toy at the right moment, and feel the wave of stress give way under your finger.***

SECTION 4

# Progression, Depth & Retention

Complexity layers in one Room at a time, and never all at once. The squeeze is the one constant skill that deepens while the board around it grows.

## Within a night

The Squish economy creates an escalating build. Early waves you can afford one or two basic toys; by the late waves you field a full, upgraded line and spend charged squishes freely. A per-night **Calm meter** fills as you land perfect squishes and clear waves cleanly. Fill it to trigger a **Hush Pulse**, a board-wide ultimate that briefly soothes every Snarl to a crawl. A single sitting gets its own arc: scrappy start, powerful finish, a satisfying ultimate.

## Across nights, the meta

- **The Shelf (collection).** Your home screen is a real shelf of squishy toys you have collected. Tapping any toy just squishes it, no stakes, so the Shelf doubles as a sensory toy box you can fidget with any time. The fidget hobby is a collecting hobby, and this is the long-term pull.
- **Texture and star upgrades.** Each Squnchie levels up by being used, plus material upgrades that visibly change its surface. A foam Squisher becomes a denser, glossier one. Growth you can see and feel.
- **Rooms (worlds).** Nights are grouped into Rooms that escalate: Bedroom Shelf, Toy Chest, Blanket Fort, Under the Bed, the Dream. Each adds new Snarls and new path shapes (branches, loops, dark stretches you cannot see far into).

THE ROOMS · DIFFICULTY AND THEME ESCALATE

| Bedroom Shelf | Toy Chest | Blanket Fort | Under the Bed | The Dream |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 straight path, Jitters only | First bends, Knots arrive | Branching paths, Sparks | Dark lanes, Pricklers | Loops and the boss Tangle |

SECTION 4

# Progression, continued

**Snarl variety drives the strategy.** Jitters (basic), Knots (tanky, soak squishes), Sparks (fast, punish an empty lane), Pricklers (armored, immune to small squishes until cracked by a charged or area hit), and Room bosses (a giant Tangle). Each new type forces a new answer, so the strategy keeps opening up rather than settling.

## What brings a player back

### Nightly Wind-Down

A daily hand-built night with a twist, framed as a bedtime ritual. Keeps a gentle streak.

### Fidget Mode

An endless, no-economy survival night. Pure sensory decompress and a high score to chase.

### Drops

New collectible textures and seasonal skins over time, earned through play, never paywalled to progress.

### Almost-there goals

Silhouettes of un-collected toys and half-filled Room stars. The complete-the-set pull, kept cozy.

**Retention thesis:** the battles give you a reason to get better, the Shelf and Fidget Mode give you a reason to come back even when you do not want a challenge, and the collection gives the whole thing a long horizon.

SECTION 5

# What Makes It Fun

The emotional core is **release**. Squnchies is built around one repeatable feeling: tension creeping in, and you squeezing it away. That is the fidget toy's whole promise; the tower defense frame gives it stakes and rhythm.

- **The squeeze itself** is designed to feel physically good: deep haptic give, a soft organic sound, a surface that jiggles. It feels good second to second, before any strategy.
- **The perfect-squish hook.** Releasing on the wobble peak for a bonus turns a calming action into a tiny skill with a reward. That is the one-more-round pull in miniature.
- **Turning chaos to calm.** Watching a jagged, twitchy wave get absorbed by your soft glowing line, and the Hush Light blooming warmer, is the payoff. You are not just winning, you are restoring calm.
- **Gentle stakes.** The tension is real but the failure is soft, so the game stays in the pleasant-challenge zone the player wants, not the white-knuckle zone they avoid.

**Why play twice:** because it feels good in your hands, because there is always one more texture to collect and one more streak to keep, and because at the end of a long day it is the thing you reach for to put your shoulders down.

SECTION 6

# If I Had More Time

Scoped out of the first version, in roughly the order I would add them. Each grows outward from the same center: keep the squeeze at the heart, and build a cozy little world around it.

- **Co-op calm (social).** Two players defend one shelf together, each squeezing their own toys. Stress relief is more fun shared. Cut from v1 because real-time squeeze sync is a large lift and the single-player loop has to be proven first.
- **Squnchie fusion.** Combine two textures into a hybrid toy (a gel-foam, a slime-bead). Deepens the collection. Cut to keep the collection legible while the core is validated.
- **Shelf decoration.** Arrange and decorate your Shelf with backdrops, nightlight colors, and little props. Pure self-expression for the cozy-collector identity, so it waits.
- **Squish puzzles.** Hand-authored nights that are tight tactical challenges (fixed Squish, exact placements) for players who do want to be tested. Cut to keep v1 focused on the soothing mainline.
- **Adaptive calm.** Quietly soften the wave when a player struggles, or a no-fail mode with no stakes at all. A game that meets you where your stress level is. Cut because it needs data from real play to tune well.




Prickly, jittery stress

Soft, glowing calm

**The vision:** keep the squeeze at the center, and grow into a cozy, collectible, optionally-social little world you keep on your phone to take the edge off the day.